

Connect Interactive Brokers (Execution Only)

Connections & Data Feeds / Setup | intermediate | 15 min to complete | DeepCharts Help Center | July 15, 2026

By the end you will have Interactive Brokers (IBKR) connected to DeepCharts for placing trades, with a real data feed driving your charts. DeepCharts connects to IBKR through the Trader Workstation (TWS) API, which means TWS must be running and logged in the whole time you use the connection.

The single most important thing to understand: IBKR delivers **aggregated** market data, not per-tick data. Aggregated data cannot build accurate order-flow tools — no footprint, delta or volume analysis. IBKR is therefore **execution only** in DeepCharts. You pair it with a real data feed (Rithmic or dxFeed) connected at the same time, and your charts read from that feed while your orders route through IBKR.

Before you start

- A Rithmic or dxFeed data feed already connected and working — [How to Connect a Rithmic Data Feed](#) or [How to Connect a dxFeed Data Feed](#) (or the free option, [Use the Free 15-Minute Delayed Data Feed](#))
- Trader Workstation (TWS) installed from the official Interactive Brokers website, with your IBKR login
- DeepCharts installed and activated — [How to Install DeepCharts and Activate Your License](#)

Steps

1. Open **Trader Workstation (TWS)** and log in with your Interactive Brokers credentials. Keep TWS open — DeepCharts cannot connect if TWS is closed.
2. In TWS, go to **Edit** → **Global Configuration** → **API** → **Settings**.
3. Enable **Enable ActiveX and Socket Clients**. Note the socket port shown in these settings — by default TWS uses 7496 for a live login and 7497 for a paper login.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] TWS Global Configuration window, API > Settings page, with Enable ActiveX and Socket Clients checked and the Socket port field visible `tw-api-settings.png`

4. Configure the trusted IP so TWS accepts the local connection:

- Uncheck **Allow connections from localhost only**.
- Click **Create** and add the IP `127.0.0.1`.
- Re-check **Allow connections from localhost only**.
- Click **Apply**, then **Yes**, then **OK**.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] TWS API settings Trusted IPs section showing `127.0.0.1` added to the list and the Allow connections from localhost only checkbox checked `tw-trusted-ips.png`

5. In DeepCharts, click **Select Connection** → **Feed Settings**, then click **Add Connection**.

6. Fill in the connection form:

- **Name** — for example "IBKR Live" or "IBKR Paper".
- **Feed Source** — select **Interactive Brokers**. **[CONFIRM: exact Feed Source label — sources show it as "Interactive Brokers" and as "IBKR (TWS API)"]**
- **Host** — `127.0.0.1` (TWS runs on the same machine).
- **Port** — 7496 for a live TWS login, 7497 for a paper TWS login. This must match the socket port from step 3.
- **Client ID** — any unique integer (for example 1). No other app connected to TWS may use the same ID.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] DeepCharts Feed Settings dialog with Feed Source set to Interactive Brokers, Host `127.0.0.1`, Port and Client ID fields filled `feed-settings-ibkr.png`

7. Click **Save**.

8. In **Select Connection**, connect the IBKR feed **and** your data feed. Both must show a green dot at the same time — IBKR for orders, the data feed for charts.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] Select Connection dropdown showing both the IBKR connection and a Rithmic or dxFeed connection, each with a green status dot `ibkr-plus-datafeed-connected.png`

9. Open **Options** → **Symbol Manage** and set the Data Feed for every exchange to your **Rithmic or dxFeed feed — never to IBKR**. If an exchange is routed to IBKR, its charts will be built from aggregated data and will look wrong. See Symbol Manage: Subscribe Exchanges and Map Your Feed.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] Symbol Manage window showing exchange rows with the Data Feed column set to the dxFeed/Rithmic connection, not IBKR `symbol-manage-route-datafeed-not-ibkr.png`

10. Open a chart, then open the **Trading Panel** (bottom-right of the chart). In the **Broker** field select **Interactive Brokers**, then select your IBKR trading account. Orders you place now route to TWS for execution while the chart keeps loading from your data feed. See Trading from the Chart.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] Trading Panel at the bottom-right of a chart with the Broker field set to Interactive Brokers and an account selected `trading-panel-ibkr-broker.png`

If you do not have a real data feed yet

Without one, your charts will be unreliable — IBKR's aggregated data is not suitable for charting or order-flow analysis. Options: the built-in free 15-minute delayed feed (Use the Free 15-Minute Delayed Data Feed), a paid dxFeed subscription (How to Buy a Data Feed and Get Your Credentials), or a direct Rithmic feed (How to Connect a Rithmic Data Feed). Connect the data feed first, then add IBKR alongside it.

Verify it worked

- The IBKR connection dot turned green within about 10 seconds, and your data feed's dot is also green.
- Charts show live, moving prices coming from the data feed.
- The Trading Panel lists Interactive Brokers as a broker and shows your account.

If something went wrong

Symptom	Likely cause
IBKR dot stays red	TWS is not running or not logged in
IBKR dot stays red, TWS is running	API socket not enabled in TWS settings (step 3)
Red dot, settings look correct	Wrong port — paper vs live mismatch between TWS and DeepCharts
Red dot, port is correct	Client ID conflict — another app is using the same ID; pick a different integer
Charts look wrong or coarse	An exchange is routed to IBKR in Symbol Manage — re-route it to your data feed, see Fix: Live Feed Connected but Chart Is Not Moving

Still stuck? Gather a Diagnostic Report: Before You Contact Support and see How to Get Help (Chat, Diagnostic Report, Support).

Related articles

- Supported Brokers, Prop Firms and Data Feeds
- How to Connect a Data Feed (Feed Settings)
- Symbol Manage: Subscribe Exchanges and Map Your Feed
- How to Connect a Rithmic Data Feed
- How to Connect a dxFeed Data Feed

- Trading Panel Reference: Every Button and Field